

COME AS YOU ARE · WEEK 1 · WELCOME & IDENTITY

ROOM AT THE TABLE

LUKE 14:15–24

“Go out to the roads and country lanes and compel them to come in, so that my house will be full.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Show that Jesus’ table still has room for the people who assume they are not invited — and that C316 exists to make that room visible in Halesowen.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 The table is bigger than the guest list

The first invitees make excuses. Jesus is not thrown. The host keeps sending invitations. God’s welcome is not limited to the people who look ready.

2 The people on the edge are not plan B

The poor, the crippled, the blind and the lame are the ones the servant is told to bring. The gospel is not a leftover. It is aimed at the ones who never expected a seat.

3 There is still room

The house is not full yet. ‘Compel them to come in’ is not force — it is urgent, personal, going-out love. C316 does not wait for people to find the door.

APPLICATION

This week, invite one person who would not assume they belong at church to sit with you on Sunday. Don’t just hope they come — go with them.

KEY LINE

Jesus still makes space for the ones who feel left out.

COME AS YOU ARE · WEEK 2 · WELCOME & IDENTITY

CURIOUS IS WELCOME

JOHN 1:35–46

“Can anything good come from Nazareth? Come and see.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Give permission to take a first step toward Jesus without having all the answers — curiosity is how faith often begins.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 The first disciples were seekers, not experts

Andrew and the other disciple follow a question more than a lecture. Jesus turns and asks, ‘What do you want?’ He starts with desire, not a test.

2 The invitation is Come and see

Philip does not win an argument with Nathanael. He offers an encounter. C316 is a church for the curious — you do not need certainty to walk through the door.

3 Curiosity is not a threat to faith

Nathanael’s scepticism (‘Can anything good come from Nazareth?’) is welcomed, not shamed. Honest questions are a doorway, not a problem to manage.

APPLICATION

Bring your real questions this Sunday. And send one curious friend a simple text: ‘Come and see. I’ll sit with you.’

KEY LINE

You don’t need all the answers to take a first step.

COME AS YOU ARE · WEEK 3 · WELCOME & IDENTITY

THE NAME ON OUR DOOR

JOHN 3:16–17

“For God so loved the world that he gave his one and only Son, that whoever believes in him shall not perish but have eternal life.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Make John 3:16 the identity on the door of C316 — God loves this street, this postcode, these people, and sent Jesus to rescue, not to shame.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 Loved — the gospel starts with God, not with us

Before we cleaned anything up, God loved. ‘The world’ includes Halesowen. The name on our door is not a brand first — it is a love story.

2 Given — love that never costs is not this love

God gave his Son. John 3:16 is not a slogan; it is a gift with a cross in the middle. We exist because of that giving.

3 Not condemned — Jesus came to save

Verse 17 stops the church from becoming a courtroom. The curious, the doubters, the followers are met with rescue, not a raised eyebrow.

APPLICATION

Learn John 3:16 by heart this week. Say it over one person in B62 0HY by name — and invite them to the house that verse built.

KEY LINE

For God so loved the world — including Halesowen.

COME AS YOU ARE · WEEK 4 · WELCOME & IDENTITY

BRING THEM WITH YOU

MARK 2:1–12

“When Jesus saw their faith, he said to the paralysed man, Son, your sins are forgiven.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Show that faith is rarely a solo project — we carry people to Jesus, and Jesus sees the faith of friends.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 Four friends did what he could not do alone

The man on the mat needed carriers. Some people will meet Jesus because someone else refused to come to church empty-handed.

2 Jesus sees their faith

Mark says ‘their’ faith. A church can believe for someone who is still on the way. Community is part of how healing starts.

3 The roof comes off when love won’t wait

They could not get through the door, so they made a hole. Creative, inconvenient love is normal in the kingdom.

APPLICATION

Name one person. Ask them this week. Offer to pick them up. Faith often starts when friends carry someone to Jesus.

KEY LINE

Faith often starts when friends carry someone to Jesus.

GONE FISHING · WEEK 1 · MISSION · CALL TO PEOPLE

THE CALL

MATTHEW 4:18–22

“Come, follow me, and I will send you out to fish for people.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Show that Jesus still calls ordinary people in ordinary places — the Christian life begins with a person, not a programme.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 The call comes in the middle of work

Peter and Andrew are casting nets. James and John are mending them. Jesus does not wait until we have sorted our diary. He walks into the working week.

2 Follow me is a person

The first discipleship curriculum is Jesus himself. We do not follow a vibe, a brand, or a five-step plan. We follow him.

3 Leaving the nets is costly and possible

They left immediately. Something about Jesus is worth the disruption. C316 is a sent people, not a seated audience.

APPLICATION

Say yes to one next step Jesus is already putting in front of you — a conversation, a Sunday, a habit, a person to fish for.

KEY LINE

Jesus still calls ordinary people from ordinary places.

GONE FISHING · WEEK 2 · MISSION · CALL TO PEOPLE

RESTORED

JOHN 21:9–17

“Simon son of John, do you love me? ... Feed my sheep.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Preach that failure is not the end of your calling. Jesus restores the failed disciple and puts them back to work.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 Breakfast for the one who denied him

Jesus does not begin with a lecture. He lights a fire and cooks fish. Grace arrives as hospitality before it arrives as a commission.

2 Love is the question

Three denials, three questions. ‘Do you love me?’ is more searching than ‘How could you?’ Jesus wants the heart, not a performance of regret.

3 Restored people are given sheep

Forgiveness is not a sofa. ‘Feed my sheep’ puts Peter back into the call. Mercy re-commissions.

APPLICATION

Bring your failure to Jesus this week instead of hiding it. Then do one small act of care for someone — feed a sheep.

KEY LINE

Failure is not the end of your calling.

GONE FISHING · WEEK 3 · MISSION · CALL TO PEOPLE

THE NET

LUKE 5:1–11

“Put out into deep water, and let down the nets for a catch.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Show that empty-night effort is not the last word — the miracle sits on the other side of obedience, and encountering Jesus undoes us then sends us.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 We fished all night

Peter is the expert, and the expert is tired. Effort without Jesus is exhaustion. Many of us know that night.

2 Deep water is where he tells us to go

The command is inconvenient and specific. The catch comes as they obey, not as they discuss the odds.

3 Go away from me, Lord — then Do not be afraid

The real miracle is not the fish. It is a holy man on his knees who is then told he will fish for people. Awe becomes calling.

APPLICATION

Do the one thing Jesus has already told you to do, even if last night was empty. Put the net down again.

KEY LINE

The miracle is on the other side of obedience.

GONE FISHING · WEEK 4 · MISSION · CALL TO PEOPLE

SENT

MATTHEW 28:16–20

“Therefore go and make disciples of all nations, baptising them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

The church does not have a mission; the mission has a church. Every disciple is sent — including the ones who still doubt.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 Some worshipped, some doubted — he still sent them

Matthew is honest. The Great Commission is given to a mixed room. You do not need to feel heroic to be sent.

2 All authority, all nations, all days

The command is as wide as the promise. ‘All’ is the word that stops us shrinking the gospel to people like us.

3 I am with you

The power for going is not our nerve. It is his presence. Sent people are accompanied people.

APPLICATION

Treat your street, workplace or school as a sending. Speak Jesus’ name once this week, and invite once.

KEY LINE

You do not need to feel ready to be sent.

WHY THIS BOOK?

2 TIMOTHY 3:14–17

“All Scripture is God-breathed and is useful for teaching, rebuking, correcting and training in righteousness.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Build a curious church’s confidence that Scripture is God’s living word — enough to grow us, correct us, and make us ready for every good work.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 Continue in what you have learned

Faith has a memory. Timothy is told to stay with the Scriptures he has known since childhood. Roots are not nostalgia; they are fuel.

2 God-breathed

The Bible is not a relic or a self-help anthology. God speaks. That is why we open it every Sunday and why we want it in our homes.

3 Useful — it trains us for a Jesus-shaped life

Teaching, rebuking, correcting, training. Scripture is pastoral and practical. It does not just inform. It forms.

APPLICATION

Read this Sunday’s passage out loud every day this week. One sitting. No commentary required. Let the word do the work.

KEY LINE

We open this book because God still speaks.

WHEN GOD FEELS QUIET

PSALM 13

“How long, Lord? Will you forget me forever? ... But I trust in your unfailing love.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Give language for the days God feels absent — honesty and trust can live in the same prayer.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 How long is a prayer, not a failure

David does not tidy up his feelings before he talks to God. Lament is faith that refuses to go silent.

2 Honesty and trust can share a psalm

The same mouth that says ‘Will you forget me?’ says ‘I trust in your unfailing love.’ Mature faith is not fake peace.

3 We keep singing because of who he is

The psalm ends in song before the circumstances have changed. We worship from the promise, not from the mood.

APPLICATION

Pray Psalm 13 out loud once this week. Don’t tidy it up. If you know someone in a ‘how long’ season, sit with them and pray it together.

KEY LINE

You can tell God the truth and still trust him.

TRUST OVER CONTROL

PROVERBS 3:5–6 · ROMANS 12:1–2

“Trust in the Lord with all your heart and lean not on your own understanding.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Trade the illusion of control for a living trust that shows up in a renewed mind and an offered life.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 Trust is a whole-heart direction

‘With all your heart’ is not a poster. It is a way of walking. Half-trust is just control with a prayer on top.

2 Stop leaning on your own understanding

Control is often fear in a smart coat. Proverbs is not anti-thought; it is anti-self-sufficiency.

3 Be transformed — trust changes how we think

Romans 12: offered bodies, renewed minds, a life that looks like worship. Trust is not a feeling. It is a new pattern.

APPLICATION

Name one thing you are gripping. Open your hands in prayer, then take the next obedient step without needing the whole map.

KEY LINE

Control is often fear in a smart coat.

PEOPLE OF THE WORD

COLOSSIANS 3:12–17

“Let the message of Christ dwell among you richly as you teach and admonish one another with all wisdom.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Form C316 as a people whose shared life is soaked in the word of Christ — character put on, Scripture in the room, worship as a whole life.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 Clothe yourselves

Compassion, kindness, humility, gentleness, patience, forgiveness, love. Character is put on, not waited for. The word makes a wardrobe.

2 Let the word dwell richly

Scripture belongs at the table, in the group, in the song — not only on the Sunday stand. A rich word makes a rich people.

3 Whatever you do

Word and worship spill into ordinary life. People of the Word are not experts. They are a community where Christ is at home.

APPLICATION

Put Colossians 3:12–17 on the fridge. Practise one ‘clothing’ this week — kindness, patience, or forgiveness — out loud, with someone.

KEY LINE

The word of Christ belongs in the room, not only on the stand.

ADVENT PRELUDE: HOPE

ISAIAH 9:2–7

“The people walking in darkness have seen a great light; on those living in the land of deep darkness a light has dawned.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Begin Advent by naming the darkness honestly and announcing the Light with confidence — hope has a name and a government.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 Hope does not deny the night

Isaiah starts with people walking in darkness. Advent is not fake cheer. It is a candle that tells the truth about the room.

2 A child is born — hope has a name

Wonderful Counsellor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace. Christmas is not a mood. It is a person.

3 Of the increase of his government there will be no end

Hope is not seasonal. The kingdom keeps expanding. C316 lights a candle for Halesowen because the Light has already dawned.

APPLICATION

Light a candle this week for someone still walking in the dark. Pray Isaiah 9 over them by name.

KEY LINE

Hope does not deny the night. It names the Light.

LIGHT FOR THE STREET · WEEK 1 · ADVENT · CHRISTMAS PEAK

PROMISE KEPT

LUKE 1:26–38

“I am the Lord’s servant. May your word to me be fulfilled.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Show that Christmas begins with a God who keeps his word — and with a yes from an unlikely girl in an ordinary town.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 The promise lands in an ordinary place

Nazareth. Mary. Not a palace. God keeps the long promise of a coming King in a room you would walk past.

2 How will this be? — questions are welcome

Mary is troubled, and she asks. Holy moments in Scripture have room for honest questions. Faith is not unthinking.

3 A yes that makes history

‘I am the Lord’s servant.’ Hope becomes flesh through obedience. Christmas is God keeping his word, and a human receiving it.

APPLICATION

Say a specific yes to God this week in one place you have been stalling. Write it down. Tell one trusted person.

KEY LINE

Christmas is a kept promise — and a human yes.

LIGHT FOR THE STREET · WEEK 2 · ADVENT · CHRISTMAS PEAK

ROOM FOR JESUS?

LUKE 2:1–7

“She wrapped him in cloths and placed him in a manger, because there was no guest room available for them.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Ask whether there is room for Jesus in our crowded lives, homes, and church — the King arrives at the edge, and a manger is enough.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 Busyness is an old problem

A census fills every room. The world is crowded when the King arrives. Our diaries are not a new excuse.

2 No guest room — the King at the edge

Jesus is born where there is no space. God does not wait to be accommodated in style. He comes to the margin.

3 A manger is enough

He does not require perfect conditions. The question for C316 is not ‘Is our setup impressive?’ It is ‘Is there room?’

APPLICATION

Make room: clear one evening, one chair at your table, one appointment this week for Jesus — and for someone who needs a seat.

KEY LINE

The King arrives at the edge. A manger is enough.

LIGHT FOR THE STREET · WEEK 3 · ADVENT · CHRISTMAS PEAK

GOOD NEWS OF GREAT JOY

LUKE 2:8–20

“I bring you good news that will cause great joy for all the people. Today in the town of David a Saviour has been born to you.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Preach Christmas as public good news for ordinary people — not a private religious feeling, but a Saviour announced to the night shift.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 The first congregation was night-shift shepherds

Good news finds the overlooked. Heaven does not debut the announcement in a palace. It goes to the field.

2 Great joy for all the people

Not a few. Not the ready. All. Christmas at C316 is for the curious, the doubters, the followers, the street.

3 They went with haste — then they told

Joy that stays silent is unfinished. The shepherds become the first preachers. We do the same.

APPLICATION

Tell one person the Christmas story in your own words this week. Invite them to C316. Joy is for passing on.

KEY LINE

Good news finds the night shift first.

LIGHT FOR THE STREET · WEEK 4 · ADVENT · CHRISTMAS PEAK

WHAT WILL YOU DO?

MATTHEW 2:1–12

“We saw his star when it rose and have come to worship him.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

After Christmas, force an honest response: worship, or notice the star and go home unchanged.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 Two sets of people saw signs

Herod and the Magi both hear. Only one set travels to worship. Information is not the same as response.

2 Control or gifts

Herod wants the child managed. The Magi bring gold, frankincense and myrrh. Christmas reveals what we do with Jesus.

3 Home by another route

Meeting Jesus changes the way back. You cannot encounter the King and walk the old road as if nothing happened.

APPLICATION

Choose your gift this week: time, repentance, generosity, or a new route home. Do not leave Christmas as a spectator.

KEY LINE

Meeting Jesus changes the way back.

NEW MERCIES · WEEK 1 · RESET · DISCIPLESHIP

MERCIES, NOT RESOLUTIONS

LAMENTATIONS 3:22–24

“Because of the Lord’s great love we are not consumed, for his compassions never fail. They are new every morning.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Start the year on mercy, not self-improvement theatre. Identity before activity. Grace before grit.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 We are not consumed

The year begins with surviving grace. Lamentations is not a spa verse — it is mercy in the rubble. That is our starting point.

2 New every morning

Yesterday’s failure does not cancel today’s mercy. Resolutions often live on shame. Mercy lives on the character of God.

3 The Lord is my portion

Identity before activity. We do not become a people of grit first. We become a people who receive.

APPLICATION

Replace one resolution with a daily mercy: ‘Lord, I receive today.’ Write Lamentations 3:22–23 where you will see it in the morning.

KEY LINE

Start the year on mercy, not on shame.

NEW MERCIES · WEEK 2 · RESET · DISCIPLESHIP

ONE STEP TOWARD JESUS

MARK 1:14–20

“The time has come. The kingdom of God has come near. Repent and believe the good news!”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Discipleship starts with one step, not a five-year plan. God has already moved — turn, trust, and follow.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 The kingdom has come near

God has already moved. We are not climbing to him. He has stepped into the street. That is why a first step is possible.

2 Repent and believe

Turn, and trust. Not a personality transplant. A direction change toward Jesus, and a confidence in the good news.

3 They left the nets at once

Delayed obedience is often disobedience wearing a planning meeting. One step is how a following life begins.

APPLICATION

Take one concrete step toward Jesus this week: come on Sunday, open Mark’s gospel, join Alpha, or tell someone you are following.

KEY LINE

You do not need a five-year plan. You need one step.

PRACTICES THAT FORM US

ACTS 2:42–47

“They devoted themselves to the apostles’ teaching and to fellowship, to the breaking of bread and to prayer.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Show that following Jesus is a shared rhythm, not a vibe — four practices that still make a church.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 They devoted themselves

Formation takes a decision, then a habit. Devotion is not intensity for a week. It is direction for a life.

2 Teaching, fellowship, bread, prayer

Four practices. Word, one another, the table, and talking to God. This is still how C316 is built.

3 The Lord added

Growth is God’s work through ordinary faithfulness. We practise. He adds. We do not have to manufacture life.

APPLICATION

Pick one Acts 2 practice and do it with someone this week — open Scripture, share a meal, pray, or show up to fellowship.

KEY LINE

Following Jesus is a rhythm, not a vibe.

WHEN COMMUNITY COSTS

HEBREWS 10:24–25

“Let us consider how we may spur one another on toward love and good deeds, not giving up meeting together, as some are in the habit of doing.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Tell the truth: real church will cost you — and presence is still a gift the world cannot replace.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 Spur one another on

We do not drift into love and good deeds. We are provoked, encouraged, sometimes inconvenienced, into them.

2 Do not give up meeting together

Absence is easy. Presence is a gift. The habit of staying away is named honestly in Scripture because it is old and it is deadly.

3 All the more as you see the Day approaching

The closer the pressure, the more we need each other. Community costs because the stakes are real.

APPLICATION

Show up this Sunday. Then notice who is missing. Make one call, one message, or one knock this week.

KEY LINE

Presence is a gift. Absence is easy.

STAY SOFT

HEBREWS 3:12–15

“Today, if you hear his voice, do not harden your hearts.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Guard against a hardened heart by practising daily encouragement and a present-tense yes to God.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 Unbelief hardens slowly

It is a drift, not a crash. The warning is for brothers and sisters, not ‘those people out there’.

2 Encourage one another daily

Softness is a community project. We stay tender because someone speaks life into us before the heart sets.

3 Today, if you hear his voice

The window is now. Delayed softness becomes hardness. Stay interruptible.

APPLICATION

Ask: where am I going hard? Confess it to God and to one trusted person. Practise a ‘today’ yes.

KEY LINE

Stay interruptible. Stay soft.

LOVE THAT STAYS · WEEK 1 · NEIGHBOURS · VISION

LOVED FIRST

1 JOHN 4:7–12

“Dear friends, let us love one another, for love comes from God. ... We love because he first loved us.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Root every act of love in the fact that we were loved first — love is received before it is performed.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 Love comes from God

We do not invent it. We do not manufacture warmth. Love is sourced in the Father.

2 God sent his Son

Love has a cost and a cross. ‘First loved’ is not a feeling; it is an event in history.

3 If we love one another, God lives in us

The proof is in the room. A church that was loved first becomes a church that stays.

APPLICATION

Do one act of love this week that costs you — because you have already been loved. Don’t wait to feel it first.

KEY LINE

We love because he first loved us.

LOVE THAT STAYS · WEEK 2 · NEIGHBOURS · VISION

LOVE YOUR NEIGHBOURS

LUKE 10:25–37

“Which of these three do you think was a neighbour to the man who fell into the hands of robbers? ... Go and do likewise.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Move neighbour-love from sentiment to interruption — mercy crosses the road, and Jesus does not leave this as a story.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 Who is my neighbour? often shrinks the list

The lawyer wants a boundary. Jesus tells a story that explodes the boundary. Neighbour is the one in front of you.

2 Mercy crosses the road

Love is what we do when it is inconvenient. The Samaritan uses time, wine, oil, money, and a return visit.

3 Go and do likewise

Jesus does not leave this as a moving tale. It is a sending. B62 0HY is the road we are on.

APPLICATION

Learn the name of one neighbour this week. Cross the road for them — a knock, a meal, a lift, a listening.

KEY LINE

Mercy crosses the road.

LOVE THAT STAYS · WEEK 3 · NEIGHBOURS · VISION

CHURCH LIKE FAMILY

ROMANS 12:9–18

“Be devoted to one another in love. Honour one another above yourselves.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

Cast a vision of church as a sincere, honouring, practical family — not an event you attend but a people you belong to.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 Love must be sincere

Drop the performance. Family that is only for Sunday smiles is not Romans 12. Hate what is evil; cling to what is good.

2 Be devoted; honour one another

Family is a way of treating people. We talk up, not down. We make room. We refuse to be too busy for each other.

3 Practise hospitality, bless, live at peace

The small stuff is the stuff. Tables, honour, weeping and rejoicing, peace as far as it depends on you.

APPLICATION

Open your home or your Sunday row this week to someone who usually sits alone. Treat C316 like family, not like an event.

KEY LINE

Church is a people you belong to, not an event you attend.

LOVE THAT STAYS · WEEK 4 · NEIGHBOURS · VISION

STILL SENT

JOHN 20:19–23

“Peace be with you! As the Father has sent me, I am sending you.”

MAIN OBJECTIVE

End the six months by sending a once-afraid church back into the world with peace and the Spirit — the story does not end in the room.

THREE PREACH POINTS

1 Locked doors are where he still walks in

Fear is not a disqualification. The risen Jesus stands among anxious people and speaks first.

2 Peace be with you

The first Easter gift is not a task. It is peace. We are not sent as frantic people. We are sent as people who have been met.

3 As the Father sent me, I am sending you

The story does not end in the locked room. C316 is still sent — into B62, into the street, into the next six months.

APPLICATION

Receive peace. Then go: one conversation, one invitation, one act of witness this week. The series ends. The sending does not.

KEY LINE

The story does not end in the locked room.